

29.4 THE SECOND CONDITIONAL

The second conditional, also called the “unreal” conditional, uses “if” to describe an unlikely or unreal action or event. The described result is also very unlikely.



HOW TO FORM

The second conditional is usually introduced by an “if” clause with a past simple verb. “Would” or “could” plus the base form of the main verb expresses the result.



FURTHER EXAMPLES

If he wasn't so busy, he'd take a break.



If I moved to Scotland, I'd live in a cottage.



If I had more time, I could take up karate.



I'd call her if I knew her number.



If I saw a ghost, I would be terrified.



If I learned English, I could visit London.

